

Catai App Plan

Purpose: Catai connects Taiwanese people with foreigners. Every feature exists to bring a local and an international student together: meeting in person, chatting across languages, going to the same events, and helping each other with school and travel.

Rollout: Canada first, then Taiwan · **Platform:** phones · **Status:** planning, no building yet

The connection at the heart of the app

Taiwanese locals offer

- Friendship and a local view of Taiwan
- Mandarin and Taiwanese practice
- Help with school, food, places and customs

Foreigners offer

- Friendship and a window on other countries
- English and French practice
- Contacts for studying or traveling abroad

Design rule: each screen should make it easy to meet someone from the other side. For example, events show how many locals and foreigners are going, and profiles show which languages a person speaks and wants to learn.

Who it's for

- **Taiwanese students and residents:** people who want to make foreign friends, practice languages and show their city. They are half of every connection, not an extra.
- **Exchange students and foreigners:** new arrivals who want Taiwanese friends, help with school paperwork, and ways to explore the country.
- **Travel agencies:** Taiwanese agencies that advertise trips to students. Later, users can book through the app.

Rollout: Canada first, then Taiwan

1. Canada (launch)

Start at universities where we already have contacts. Connect Taiwanese exchange students and residents in Canada with Canadian students, and help Canadians who plan to study or travel in Taiwan.

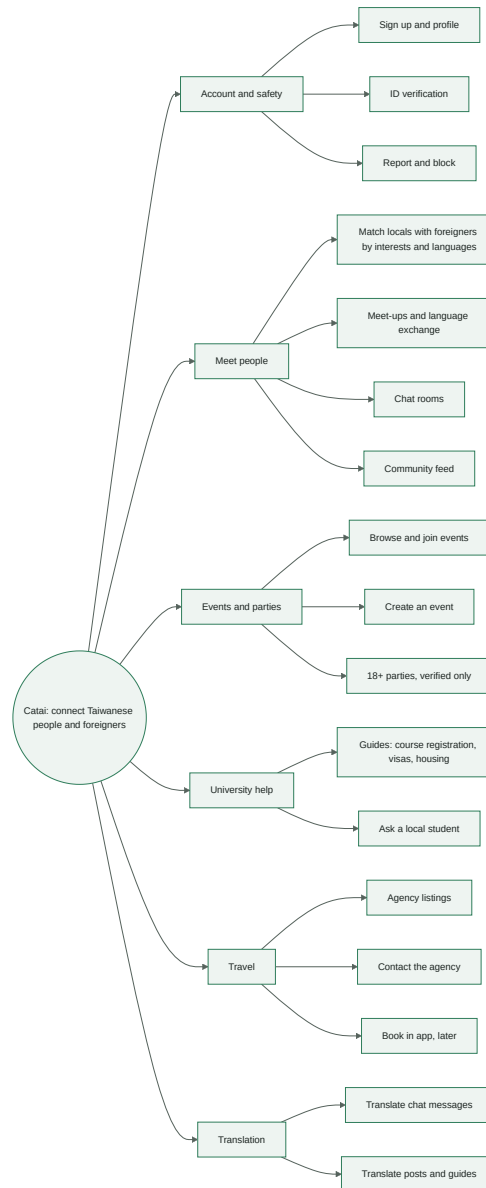
Why first: we know the schools, the course registration steps and the people, so the guides and first events are easier to get right.

2. Taiwan (expansion)

Once the app works well in Canada, open it in Taiwan for foreigners arriving there and the Taiwanese locals who want to meet them. Add Taiwanese university guides and the travel agency listings at this stage.

Bonus: Canadians who used the app at home can keep their Taiwanese friends when they go on exchange.

Feature map

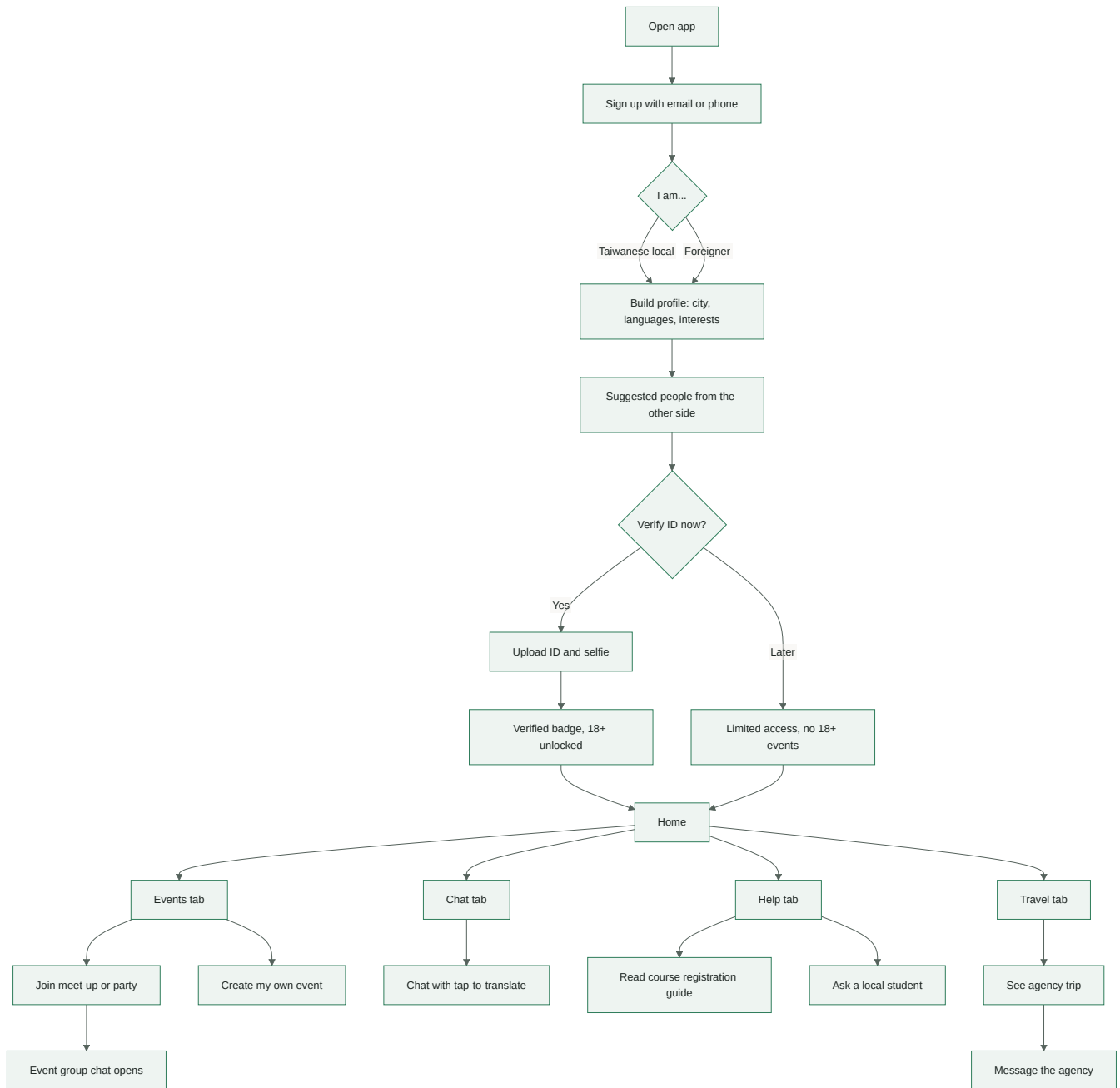


Main features

Feature	What it does	Version
Profiles and ID verification	Name, photo, school, country, languages and interests. Verified ID unlocks 18+ events and adds a badge.	1
Meet-ups	Small casual plans like coffee, hikes or language exchange, filtered by city.	1
Chat rooms	Private chats, group chats for each event, and city rooms.	1
Translation	A translate button on every message and post, covering Mandarin, English and French.	1
Events and parties	Upcoming events with join buttons. Parties are marked 18+ and only verified users can join.	1
University help	Step-by-step guides per school, for example how to register for classes, plus questions answered by locals.	1
Travel agencies	Agencies post trips. Students contact them first; booking and payment in the app come later.	2
International community	A shared feed, groups by interest, and friends that carry over between Canada and Taiwan.	2

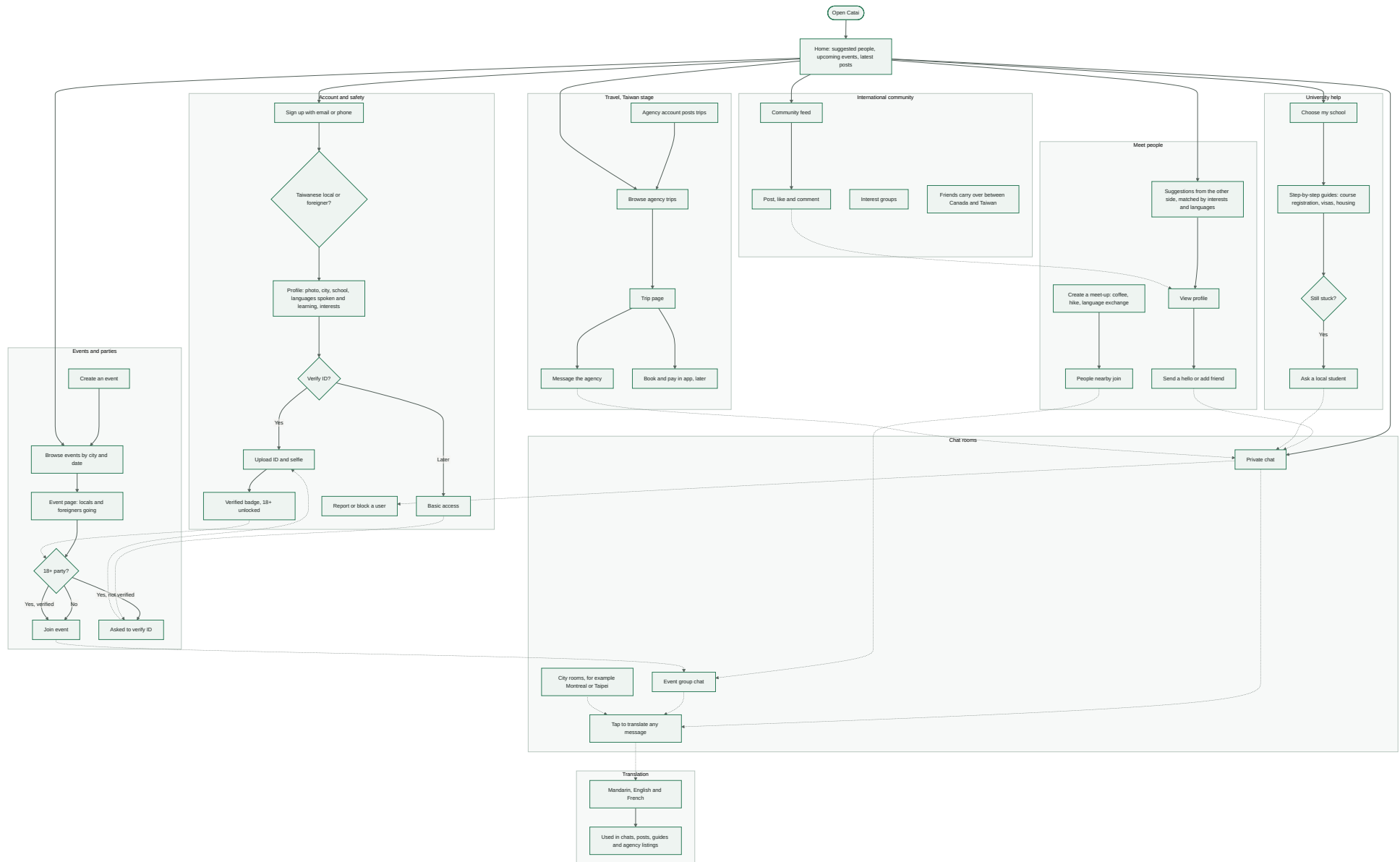
User flow

How a new user moves through the app. A bottom tab bar keeps the layout simple: Home, Events, Chat, Help, Profile.



Flow chart of all features

How every feature works step by step, and how the features lead into each other. Dotted arrows show where one feature hands off to another.



Build phases

1. **Clickable prototype:** phone-sized screens with sample data to test the layout and flow with a few Taiwanese and Canadian students in Canada. No accounts or servers yet.
2. **Working web app:** real sign-up, profiles, events and chat with a hosted backend such as Firebase or Supabase. Translation through a translation API.
3. **Phone app:** iPhone and Android apps, for example with React Native or Capacitor, which reuse the web code. ID verification with a provider such as Stripe Identity or Persona.
4. **Canada launch:** release at the first Canadian universities, with French and English guides and real events.
5. **Taiwan expansion, agencies and booking:** open in Taiwan, add Taiwanese university guides, agency accounts, trip listings and contact forms; in-app booking and payments after that.

Things to decide

- ☐ Which Canadian universities to launch at first, and which Taiwanese ones to add after
- ☐ Rules for events and parties: who can create them, and how to keep them safe
- ☐ Privacy rules for storing IDs: Canada's PIPEDA and Quebec's Law 25 for the launch, then Taiwan's Personal Data Protection Act
- ☐ How the app earns money, for example agency ads or booking fees